Secrets of Strixhaven Report: Learned Archetypes, Bombs, and Synergies

MTGNET

October 27, 2026

Dataset Snapshot

This run on Secrets of Strixhaven uses 132,902 unique deck builds and 582,914 game rows. The unsupervised clustering stage produced 6 learned archetypes. Card win rates are games-in-hand (GIH) win rates; an archetype's win rate is over all of its games. The best-performing large shells are Boros | Pursue the Past / Wilt in the Heat, Orzhov | Render Speechless / Melancholic Poet, Temur | Potioner's Trove / Snarl Song, which already tells us that the format is not a single monolithic color table: it separates into distinct deck families with their own signposts, core cards, and standalone bombs.

How to Read This Report

- **Coreness** measures how central a card is to an archetype: played in many of its decks, characteristic of it, and connected to the rest of the deck. Cards are grouped into Core, Support and Periphery rings. A core card may carry a tag: **signature** (in bold: played in at least 15% of this archetype's decks and in at most one other archetype at that rate) or *staple* (at least 25% of this archetype's decks and at least 15% in three or more archetypes); untagged core cards are neither.
- **Play rate** is the share of the archetype's decks that play at least one copy.
- **Bombs** are cards that are strong on their own. A bomb's **lift** compares, within the decks that play it, the win rate when the card is in hand with the win rate when it stayed in the library, relative to a typical card of the archetype, and is shrunk across archetypes; it is shown in percentage points (pp). Bombs are listed whatever ring they sit in: core and support bombs keep their ring on the site, and only bombs that would otherwise be peripheral go to the bomb island beside the rings.
- A **synergy pair** wins more often when both cards are drawn than their separate effects predict (games-in-hand, adjusted for game length and play/draw). The effect λ is an interaction log-odds, shown as a percentage change in the odds of winning with its 95% confidence interval. Pairs are tested with Benjamini–Hochberg false-discovery control: *verified* means $q \leq 0.10$, *tentative* means $q \leq 0.25$. Few pairs pass; an absent pair means "not detectable with this data", not "no synergy".

- **Payoff** and **engine** roles are decided by synergy arrows only: the synergy pairs (verified or tentative) whose direction is significant. In such a pair the arrow points from the payoff, the card that wins more when drawn without its partner, to the engine it rewards; a card whose arrows mostly point out of it is a payoff, one whose arrows mostly point into it an engine. The arrow reflects each card's standalone strength within the pair, not a direction of the synergy itself. Played-together links carry the same arrow on the site as context only; they do not set roles.

1 Discovered Archetypes

Archetype	Decks	Games	WR	Top signposts
Boros | Pursue the Past / Wilt in the Heat	28,041	129,658	57.15%	Pursue the Past, Wilt in the Heat, Rubble Rouser, Stone Docent, Ascendant Dustspeaker
Orzhov | Render Speechless / Melancholic Poet	23,259	106,911	57.15%	Render Speechless, Melancholic Poet, Imperious Inkmage, Elite Interceptor, Cost of Brilliance
Temur | Potioner's Trove / Snarl Song	19,123	81,474	55.78%	Potioner's Trove, Snarl Song, Arcane Omens, Embrace the Paradox, Sundering Archaic
Golgari | Grapple with Death / Bogwater Lumaret	19,201	82,121	53.92%	Grapple with Death, Bogwater Lumaret, Send in the Pest, Pest Mascot, Mindful Biomancer
Izzet Sorcerer | Visionary's Dance / Elemental Mascot	27,551	116,166	53.74%	Visionary's Dance, Elemental Mascot, Essence Scatter, Hydro-Channeler, Sanar, Unfinished Genius
Simic | Pterafractyl / Fractal Mascot	15,727	66,584	53.29%	Pterafractyl, Fractal Mascot, Embrace the Paradox, Noxious Newt, Paradox Surveyor

2 Core of Each Archetype

The core ring of each archetype, most central first, with the share of the archetype's decks that play each card and its tag where it has one: **signature** (in bold) or staple. The second line lists the archetype's bombs, whatever ring they sit in: cards that are strong on their own, with their lift (in-hand vs in-library win rate within the decks that play them, relative to a typical card of the archetype, shrunk across archetypes) and their games in hand.

Archetype	Core cards (play rate)
Boros 28,041 decks	**Spirit Mascot** (63%, signature), **Pursue the Past** (64%, signature), **Rubble Rouser** (60%, signature), **Wilt in the Heat** (63%, signature), **Owlin Historian** (42%, signature), **Ascendant Dustspeaker** (43%, signature), **Garrison Excavator** (35%, signature), **Stone Docent** (53%, signature), **Living History** (33%, signature), **Kirol, History Buff** (37%, signature) *Bombs:* Antiquities on the Loose (+10.7 pp, 9,174 games); Practiced Offense (+10.1 pp, 7,470 games); Ark of Hunger (+9.3 pp, 11,083 games); Together as One (+8.8 pp, 1,898 games)
Izzet Sorcerer 27,551 decks	**Visionary's Dance** (55%, signature), **Elemental Mascot** (44%, signature), Run Behind (43%, staple), **Stadium Tidalmage** (33%, signature), Essence Scatter (48%, staple), Hydro-Channeler (41%, staple) *Bombs:* Together as One (+8.8 pp, 3,904 games); Emeritus of Ideation (+8.7 pp, 3,399 games); Colorstorm Stallion (+7.5 pp, 9,971 games); Antiquities on the Loose (+6.5 pp, 679 games)
Orzhov 23,259 decks	**Render Speechless** (57%, signature), **Imperious Inkmage** (59%, signature), **Melancholic Poet** (52%, signature), **Inkling Mascot** (66%, signature), **Cost of Brilliance** (49%, signature), **Scolding Administrator** (41%, signature), **Killian's Confidence** (36%, signature), **Snooping Page** (36%, signature), **Lecturing Scornmage** (34%, signature), **Dig Site Inventory** (41%, signature) *Bombs:* Practiced Offense (+10.2 pp, 5,880 games); Stirring Hopesinger (+8.0 pp, 6,644 games); Moment of Reckoning (+7.8 pp, 8,585 games); Together as One (+7.8 pp, 853 games)
Golgari 19,201 decks	**Bogwater Lumaret** (66%, signature), **Pest Mascot** (59%, signature), Grapple with Death (60%, staple), **Send in the Pest** (47%, signature), **Shopkeeper's Bane** (39%, signature), **Burrog Barrage** (43%, signature), **Mindful Biomancer** (44%, signature), **Teacher's Pest** (35%, signature), **Poisoner's Apprentice** (31%, signature), **Essenceknit Scholar** (37%, signature) *Bombs:* Germination Practicum (+9.5 pp, 2,284 games); Together as One (+9.3 pp, 1,695 games); Professor Dellian Fel (+7.2 pp, 2,788 games); Moment of Reckoning (+7.0 pp, 1,050 games)
Temur 19,123 decks	Potioner's Trove (64%, staple), **Snarl Song** (49%, signature), **Arcane Omens** (39%, signature), **Embrace the Paradox** (44%, signature), **Sundering Archaic** (38%, signature), **Transcendent Archaic** (28%, signature), Studious First-Year (38%, staple), **Rancorous Archaic** (25%, signature) *Bombs:* Together as One (+9.6 pp, 8,003 games); Subterranean Tremors (+8.4 pp, 421 games); Emeritus of Ideation (+7.7 pp, 1,613 games); Snarl Song (+6.0 pp, 22,802 games)
Simic 15,727 decks	**Pterafractyl** (54%, signature), **Burrog Barrage** (43%, signature), **Fractal Mascot** (49%, signature), **Embrace the Paradox** (50%, signature), Noxious Newt (50%, staple), **Cuboid Colony** (38%, signature), Studious First-Year (52%, staple), **Paradox Surveyor** (40%, signature), **Fractal Tender** (32%, signature), **Proctor's Gaze** (34%, signature) *Bombs:* Together as One (+10.0 pp, 2,170 games); Emeritus of Ideation (+8.8 pp, 1,666 games); Quandrix, the Proof (+5.4 pp, 2,426 games); Practiced Offense (+5.3 pp, 445 games)

3 What Defines the Best Shells

Boros | Pursue the Past / Wilt in the Heat

This cluster contains 28,041 decks across 129,658 games and posts a baseline win rate of 57.15%. Its core (the cards most central to it) is `Spirit Mascot` (63% of decks), `Pursue the Past` (64% of decks), `Rubble Rouser` (60% of decks), `Wilt in the Heat` (63% of decks), `Owlin Historian` (42% of decks). Its defining signposts are `Pursue the Past`, `Wilt in the Heat`, `Rubble Rouser`, `Stone Docent`, `Ascendant Dustspeaker`, `Spirit Mascot`.

Bombs that win on their own here: `Antiquities on the Loose` (+10.7 pp), `Practiced Offense` (+10.1 pp), `Ark of Hunger` (+9.3 pp). Out of 496 card pairs tested, 5 are verified synergies (BH $q \leq 0.10$) and 14 tentative ($q \leq 0.25$). The strongest verified pair is `Rubble Rouser` + `Spirit Mascot`: +14% odds of winning when both are drawn (95% CI [+8, +19]%, 17,049 games). Among its synergy pairs with a significant direction, the payoffs (cards that win more when drawn than their partners) are `Hardened Academic`, `Practiced Offense`, `Rubble Rouser` and the engines they reward are `Dig Site Inventory`, `Eager Glyphmage`, `Soaring Stoneglider`.

Orzhov | Render Speechless / Melancholic Poet

This cluster contains 23,259 decks across 106,911 games and posts a baseline win rate of 57.15%. Its core (the cards most central to it) is `Render Speechless` (57% of decks), `Imperious Inkmage` (59% of decks), `Melancholic Poet` (52% of decks), `Inkling Mascot` (66% of decks), `Cost of Brilliance` (49% of decks). Its defining signposts are `Render Speechless`, `Melancholic Poet`, `Imperious Inkmage`, `Elite Interceptor`, `Cost of Brilliance`, `Inkling Mascot`.

Bombs that win on their own here: `Practiced Offense` (+10.2 pp), `Stirring Hopesinger` (+8.0 pp), `Moment of Reckoning` (+7.8 pp). Out of 496 card pairs tested, 16 are verified synergies (BH $q \leq 0.10$) and 14 tentative ($q \leq 0.25$). The strongest verified pair is `Cost of Brilliance` + `Melancholic Poet`: +17% odds of winning when both are drawn (95% CI [+10, +25]%, 7,770 games). Among its synergy pairs with a significant direction, the payoffs (cards that win more when drawn than their partners) are `Melancholic Poet`, `Informed Inkwright`, `Scolding Administrator` and the engines they reward are `Killian's Confidence`, `Dig Site Inventory`, `Masterful Flourish`.

Temur | Potioner's Trove / Snarl Song

This cluster contains 19,123 decks across 81,474 games and posts a baseline win rate of 55.78%. Its core (the cards most central to it) is `Potioner's Trove` (64% of decks), `Snarl Song` (49% of decks), `Arcane Omens` (39% of decks), `Embrace the Paradox` (44% of decks), `Sundering Archaic` (38% of decks). Its defining signposts are `Potioner's Trove`, `Snarl Song`, `Arcane Omens`, `Embrace the Paradox`, `Sundering Archaic`, `Archaic's Agony`.

Bombs that win on their own here: `Together as One` (+9.6 pp), `Subterranean Tremors` (+8.4 pp), `Emeritus of Ideation` (+7.7 pp). Out of 496 card pairs tested, 5 are verified synergies (BH $q \leq 0.10$) and 4 tentative ($q \leq 0.25$). The strongest verified pair is `Shared Roots` + `Transcendent Archaic`: +28% odds of winning when both are drawn (95% CI [+12, +46]%, 1,430 games). Among its synergy pairs with a significant direction, the payoffs (cards that win more when drawn than their partners) are `Sundering Archaic`.

Golgari | Grapple with Death / Bogwater Lumaret

This cluster contains 19,201 decks across 82,121 games and posts a baseline win rate of 53.92%. Its core (the cards most central to it) is `Bogwater Lumaret` (66% of decks), `Pest Mascot` (59% of decks), `Grapple with Death` (60% of decks), `Send in the Pest` (47% of decks), `Shopkeeper's Bane` (39% of decks). Its defining signposts are `Grapple with Death`, `Bogwater Lumaret`, `Send in the Pest`, `Pest Mascot`, `Mindful Biomancer`, `Shopkeeper's Bane`.

Bombs that win on their own here: `Germination Practicum` (+9.5 pp), `Together as One` (+9.3 pp), `Professor Dellian Fel` (+7.2 pp). Out of 496 card pairs tested, 9 are verified synergies (BH q $\leq$ 0.10) and 14 tentative (q $\leq$ 0.25). The strongest verified pair is `Bogwater Lumaret` + `Pest Mascot`: +20% odds of winning when both are drawn (95% CI [+13, +28]%, 9,984 games). Among its synergy pairs with a significant direction, the payoffs (cards that win more when drawn than their partners) are `Essenceknit Scholar`, `Blech, Loafing Pest`, `Postmortem Professor` and the engines they reward are `Comforting Counsel`, `Grapple with Death`, `Pest Mascot`.

4 Bombs: Cards That Are Good Alone

Cards flagged as bombs in at least one archetype, whatever ring they sit in on the site, each shown in the archetype where its lift is largest. *Lift*: within the decks that play the card, the win rate when it is in hand vs when it stayed in the library, relative to a typical card of the archetype, shrunk across archetypes. *Raw lift*: the card's games-in-hand win rate minus the archetype baseline, not shrunk.

Card	Archetype	Lift	Raw lift	GIH WR	Games
`Antiquities on the Loose`	Boros	+10.7 pp	+9.9 pp	67.04%	9,174
`Practiced Offense`	Orzhov	+10.2 pp	+9.9 pp	67.09%	5,880
`Together as One`	Simic	+10.0 pp	+11.1 pp	64.42%	2,170
`Germination Practicum`	Golgari	+9.5 pp	+8.3 pp	62.26%	2,284
`Ark of Hunger`	Boros	+9.3 pp	+9.1 pp	66.29%	11,083
`Emeritus of Ideation`	Simic	+8.8 pp	+13.2 pp	66.51%	1,666
`Subterranean Tremors`	Temur	+8.4 pp	+10.3 pp	66.03%	421
`Stirring Hopesinger`	Orzhov	+8.0 pp	+7.2 pp	64.31%	6,644
`Moment of Reckoning`	Orzhov	+7.8 pp	+7.5 pp	64.60%	8,585
`Colorstorm Stallion`	Izzet Sorcerer	+7.5 pp	+9.4 pp	63.17%	9,971
`Professor Dellian Fel`	Golgari	+7.2 pp	+8.2 pp	62.16%	2,788
`Postmortem Professor`	Golgari	+7.0 pp	+7.9 pp	61.81%	4,795
`Blech, Loafing Pest`	Golgari	+6.1 pp	+6.4 pp	60.33%	7,432
`Snarl Song`	Temur	+6.0 pp	+7.8 pp	63.59%	22,802

5 Build-Arounds and Shell Dependence

Card	Best cluster	Shell dependence	Support delta	Supported games
Spirit Mascot	Boros | Pursue the Past / Wilt in the Heat	10.0 / 10	15.68 pp	47152
Owlin Historian	Boros | Pursue the Past / Wilt in the Heat	10.0 / 10	17.45 pp	28118
Render Speechless	Orzhov | Render Speechless / Melancholic Poet	10.0 / 10	29.46 pp	31961
Inkling Mascot	Orzhov | Render Speechless / Melancholic Poet	10.0 / 10	19.28 pp	38194
Pterafractyl	Simic | Pterafractyl / Fractal Mascot	10.0 / 10	23.48 pp	19580
Pest Mascot	Golgari | Grapple with Death / Bogwater Lumaret	10.0 / 10	17.10 pp	25981
Send in the Pest	Golgari | Grapple with Death / Bogwater Lumaret	10.0 / 10	17.32 pp	19761
Dig Site Inventory	Boros | Pursue the Past / Wilt in the Heat	9.8 / 10	19.98 pp	19820
Garrison Excavator	Boros | Pursue the Past / Wilt in the Heat	9.8 / 10	16.09 pp	22717
Living History	Boros | Pursue the Past / Wilt in the Heat	9.7 / 10	13.66 pp	21668
Killian's Confidence	Orzhov | Render Speechless / Melancholic Poet	9.7 / 10	28.29 pp	17042
Burrog Barrage	Golgari | Grapple with Death / Bogwater Lumaret	9.7 / 10	20.36 pp	16637

6 Dependency Cards

Card	Best cluster	Dependency	Standalone lift	Games
Together as One	Izzet Sorcerer | Visionary's Dance / Elemental Mascot	0.407	10.94 pp	3904
Divergent Equation	Izzet Sorcerer | Visionary's Dance / Elemental Mascot	0.331	3.78 pp	14470
Pterafractyl	Simic | Pterafractyl / Fractal Mascot	0.299	1.21 pp	19791
Geometer's Arthropod	Simic | Pterafractyl / Fractal Mascot	0.299	1.99 pp	3712

Card	Best cluster	Dependency	Standalone lift	Games
Resonating Lute	Izzet Sorcerer | Visionary's Dance / Elemental Mascot	0.280	3.40 pp	7636
Exhibition Tidecaller	Izzet Sorcerer | Visionary's Dance / Elemental Mascot	0.273	7.85 pp	8328
Blech, Loafing Pest	Golgari | Grapple with Death / Bogwater Lumaret	0.261	6.41 pp	7432
Stirring Hopesinger	Boros | Pursue the Past / Wilt in the Heat	0.237	6.38 pp	6221
Brush Off	Izzet Sorcerer | Visionary's Dance / Elemental Mascot	0.234	3.71 pp	13115
Splatter Technique	Izzet Sorcerer | Visionary's Dance / Elemental Mascot	0.234	7.23 pp	10115
Visionary's Dance	Izzet Sorcerer | Visionary's Dance / Elemental Mascot	0.231	1.71 pp	36180
Lluwen, Exchange Student	Golgari | Grapple with Death / Bogwater Lumaret	0.230	2.88 pp	12672

7 Best Draft Priorities

Card	Best cluster	Pick score	Draft win lift	Rarity
Together as One	Temur | Potioner's Trove / Snarl Song	10.0 / 10	4.49 pp	rare
Snarl Song	Temur | Potioner's Trove / Snarl Song	10.0 / 10	1.95 pp	uncommon
Ark of Hunger	Boros | Pursue the Past / Wilt in the Heat	10.0 / 10	4.18 pp	rare
Antiquities on the Loose	Boros | Pursue the Past / Wilt in the Heat	10.0 / 10	3.94 pp	rare
Colorstorm Stallion	Izzet Sorcerer | Visionary's Dance / Elemental Mascot	10.0 / 10	3.18 pp	rare
Stress Dream	Izzet Sorcerer | Visionary's Dance / Elemental Mascot	10.0 / 10	2.14 pp	uncommon
Practiced Offense	Orzhov | Render Speechless / Melancholic Poet	10.0 / 10	4.52 pp	rare

Card	Best cluster	Pick score	Draft win lift	Rarity
Essenceknit Scholar	Golgari | Grapple with Death / Bogwater Lumaret	10.0 / 10	1.90 pp	uncommon
Moment of Reckoning	Orzhov | Render Speechless / Melancholic Poet	10.0 / 10	2.73 pp	rare
Arcane Omens	Temur | Potioner's Trove / Snarl Song	9.4 / 10	1.30 pp	uncommon
Blech, Loafing Pest	Golgari | Grapple with Death / Bogwater Lumaret	10.0 / 10	1.94 pp	rare
Splatter Technique	Izzet Sorcerer | Visionary's Dance / Elemental Mascot	9.8 / 10	2.23 pp	rare

8 Verified Synergy Pairs

Every pair below passed a pair-interaction test on games-in-hand data, stratified by game length and play/draw, with Benjamini–Hochberg false-discovery control across all pairs tested in its archetype. λ is the interaction log-odds, shown as the change in the odds of winning when both cards are drawn, with its 95% confidence interval. Across all archetypes, 42 pairs are verified ($q \leq 0.10$) and 52 tentative ($q \leq 0.25$, marked †).

Pair	Archetype	Odds	95% CI	q	Pair WR	Games
Bogwater Lumaret + Pest Mascot	Golgari	+20%	[+13, +28]%	<0.001	58.17%	9,984
Divergent Equation + Resonating Lute	Izzet Sorcerer	+47%	[+28, +70]%	<0.001	67.49%	1,132
Rubble Rouser + Spirit Mascot	Boros	+14%	[+8, +19]%	<0.001	60.44%	17,049
Garrison Excavator + Rubble Rouser	Boros	+17%	[+10, +24]%	<0.001	62.43%	8,607
Cost of Brilliance + Melancholic Poet	Orzhov	+17%	[+10, +25]%	<0.001	61.60%	7,770
Bogwater Lumaret + Poisoner's Apprentice	Golgari	+22%	[+12, +33]%	0.001	60.70%	4,440
Resonating Lute + Visionary's Dance	Izzet Sorcerer	+26%	[+14, +39]%	0.002	62.18%	2,742
Poisoner's Apprentice + Send in the Pest	Golgari	+22%	[+12, +34]%	0.002	60.60%	3,086
Geometer's Arthropod + Pterafractyl	Simic	+35%	[+17, +55]%	0.011	60.43%	1,572
Killian's Confidence + Melancholic Poet	Orzhov	+16%	[+8, +25]%	0.014	60.89%	4,950
Blech, Loafing Pest + Teacher's Pest	Golgari	+30%	[+13, +49]%	0.016	66.97%	1,220
Divergent Equation + Exhibition Tidecaller	Izzet Sorcerer	+31%	[+14, +51]%	0.016	69.05%	1,121

Pair	Archetype	Odds	95% CI	q	Pair WR	Games
Brush Off + Splatter Technique	Izzet Sorcerer	+26%	[+11, +44]%	0.028	68.88%	1,356
Dig Site Inventory + Stirring Hopesinger	Boros	+27%	[+10, +46]%	0.030	65.90%	1,126
Dig Site Inventory + Scolding Administrator	Orzhov	+15%	[+6, +25]%	0.031	62.94%	4,074
Killian's Confidence + Lecturing Scornmage	Orzhov	+17%	[+6, +28]%	0.033	61.98%	2,967
Resonating Lute + Run Behind	Izzet Sorcerer	+22%	[+9, +36]%	0.033	62.59%	1,906
Poisoner's Apprentice + Teacher's Pest	Golgari	+21%	[+8, +34]%	0.033	61.18%	2,089
Pest Mascot + Teacher's Pest	Golgari	+15%	[+6, +24]%	0.033	57.99%	4,680
Informed Inkwright + Killian's Confidence	Orzhov	+25%	[+9, +44]%	0.035	67.51%	1,228
Informed Inkwright + Render Speechless	Orzhov	+21%	[+8, +36]%	0.035	66.29%	2,044
Killian's Confidence + Snooping Page	Orzhov	+15%	[+5, +25]%	0.039	60.19%	3,366
Eager Glyphmage + Practiced Offense	Orzhov	+25%	[+8, +45]%	0.053	70.22%	1,145
Dig Site Inventory + Stirring Hopesinger	Orzhov	+23%	[+7, +42]%	0.053	67.54%	1,334

9 Anti-Synergies Worth Respecting

Pairs whose interaction is significantly negative ($q \leq 0.10$): they win less often when drawn together than their separate effects predict.

Pair	Archetype	Odds	95% CI	Pair WR	Games
Antiquities on the Loose + Hydro-Channeler	Izzet Sorcerer	-44%	[-61, -18]%	53.29%	167
Colorstorm Stallion + Exhibition Tidecaller	Izzet Sorcerer	-30%	[-42, -16]%	62.79%	551
Germination Practicum + Pest Mascot	Golgari	-28%	[-41, -12]%	57.43%	606
Postmortem Professor + Teacher's Pest	Golgari	-27%	[-38, -14]%	56.95%	755
Antiquities on the Loose + Hardened Academic	Boros	-25%	[-37, -11]%	64.27%	694
Practiced Offense + Silverquill Charm	Orzhov	-24%	[-35, -12]%	64.48%	991
Expressive Firedancer + Resonating Lute	Izzet Sorcerer	-24%	[-34, -12]%	52.71%	848
Exhibition Tidecaller + Expressive Firedancer	Izzet Sorcerer	-23%	[-32, -12]%	58.03%	1,084
Moseo, Vein's New Dean + Tenured Concocter	Golgari	-23%	[-35, -8]%	54.08%	686

Pair			Archetype	Odds	95% CI	Pair WR	Games
Eager Glyphmage	+	Mage Tower Referee	Boros	-22%	[-34, -9]%	50.06%	779

10 Bottom-Line Reading

This report treats the format as a deck ecosystem rather than a flat card ranking. Each archetype is described first by its core: the cards that are played in most of its decks, characteristic of it and connected to the rest of the deck. Bombs are listed separately because they win on their own and are worth taking (and often splashing) whatever the shell. Synergy claims are deliberately conservative: only pairs that survive a false-discovery-controlled interaction test are reported, with their effect size and confidence interval, so the short pair list is a feature of honest statistics rather than a lack of interplay between the cards.